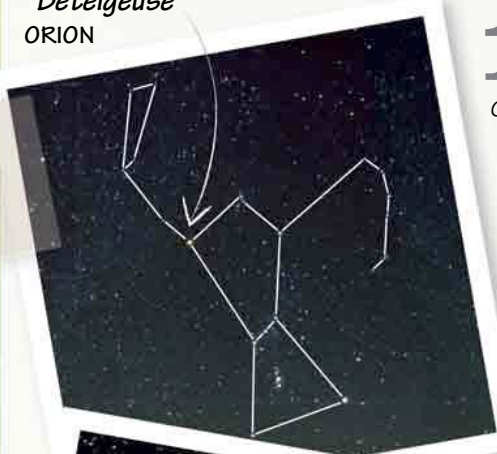


305 Spot constellations in the night sky

30
MINS

In ancient times, people grouped stars into constellations to help find their way at night. Many were named after legendary figures and animals. Find a star map, wait for a clear night, and see how many you can find.

Betelgeuse
ORION



1 Orion the Hunter is easy to spot in both hemispheres because it's one of the largest figures in the sky. Look for three bluish stars in a diagonal line that form his "belt," then look up from those to the bright red star, Betelgeuse, that marks his shoulder.

2 Leo the Lion is another easy one to find. The stars that make up its head and chest form a sickle shape, like a reversed question mark. You can often spot planets here, too.

3 Use your star map to help you locate other constellations, such as the Big and Little Dippers (or Bears) and Cassiopeia.

LEO

306 Find Venus

3
MINS

Look west, just after sunset, and you'll see a very bright, white-looking "star" in the sky. This is actually the planet Venus. It's so bright you can sometimes see it in the daytime.

Venus rising

